April 29, 1947

FACT SHEET

On Pending Anti-Labor Legislation

1. Motivation

The sponsors of this legislation claim Congress has a mandate from the American people to pass "labor" legislation. They base this claim on the results of the 1946 election. Undoubtedly the voters were disturbed in that election by postwar shortages, the slowness of reconversion, the failure of Government controls and recurring labor-management strikes. The people were sick of war on the industrial front. They wanted peace and production.

Taking advantage of this "mandate", the anti-labor crowd are now trying to cram down the public's throat legislation actually intended to destroy free trade unionism in America. This is not a program for labor-management peace, but for complete chaos in the nation's industrial life. As the debate progresses, the proponents of this legislation are coming out from behind their hypocritical mask and exposing their real motives. Rep. Fred Hartley, Chairman of the House Labor Committee, said during the House debate on his bill (which was later adopted by an almost 3 to 1 vote):

> "The purpose of this legislation is to break the unions down to the local level."

Senator Robert Taft, Chairman of the Senate Labor Committee, said on the opening day of debate on the Senate Bill:

> "The purpose of this bill is to weaken the power of labor unions." A few days later he told the American Newspaper Publishers Association in New York City that the bill includes many of the matters "which were strenuously pressed upon us by employers."

Thus the cat is being let out of the bag. Do the American people believe that the way to labor peace and more cooperative labor-management relations lies in crippling the power of the trade unions to serve their 15 million members effectively?

A FEW QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS

What is wrong on the industrial front?

Why all these strikes?

What are the facts, the rights and wrongs?

1. Any fair minded study will show that labor-management strife is the exception rather than the rule. Wherever management accepts its legal duty to bargain sincerely with the union representing its employes, trouble disappears. It is only when management continues aggressive warfare against unionism and resists efforts of the workers to get their fair share of the rewards of increased production that war breaks out. Such war is provoked -- deliberately in many cases - by employers. Yet for every strike there are 999 other cases of new contracts agreed upon around the bargaining table without loss of production.

2 - True, 1946 was a record-breaking year for strikes. Why? The answer is obvious. Postwar maladjustments, which afflicted every phase of the nation's economy, had to be ironed out. Long-postponed increases in wage rates, to make up for loss of wartime take-home pay, were refused to labor by management in many instances until and unless the Government granted price increases. This was true in many cases where management could have absorbed increased labor costs without increasing prices. Management's policy was directed not only at resisting profit-sharing through wage adjustments but at breaking down the whole system of Government controls.

3 - No one person knows all the facts and all the answers. That is why President Truman urged Congres in 1946 to create a fact-finding investigation before attempting to pass labor legislation. The American Federation of Labor endorsed this proposal. Labor is not afraid of the facts. But Congress spurned the idea and passed the anti-labor Case Bill, which the President vetoed. Again this year, the President urged Congress to authorize a fact-finding investigation. Again Congress is ignoring his wise advice. Instead it is rushing headlong into the worst legislative blunder in United States history.

SPECIFIC PROVISIONS OF THE TAFT-HARTLEY PROGRAM

1. Damage Suits Against Labor Unions

The Hartley Bill (House) permits suits in the Federal Courts by employers against unions to collect damages for alleged breach of collective bargaining contracts. It also permits the Federal Courts to issue injunctions in such cases, presumably to restrain strikes in violation of contract.

The Taft Bill (Senate) likewise permits damage suits.

CLAIM

The claim of the sponsors of these provisions is that it will impose "responsibility" upon unions. They say unions can now violate contracts with impunity and that they should be held to account.

TRUTH

The truth is that the sole purpose of these provisions is to arm recalcitrant employers with a weapon which can wreck unions. No decent employer who wants the good will of his workers and wants to stay in business is going to go to court and sue unions for damages. It is only the exceptional case of an employer who is so bitter and vengeful that he is determined to destroy the union at no matter what cost to his own business that these provisions are drafted to cover. The idea of improving labor-management relations through lawsuits for damages is just plain lunatic. Yet it is very easy to comprehend how a union can be tied up and bankrupted through fighting a multiplicity of damage suits and writs brought by a labor-hating employer. Of course unions are responsible for their actions today. They can be sued for damages in the courts of three-fourths of the States, just as any other unincorporated association can be sued. An attempt is made in the Taft-Hartley Bills to sugar-coat the pill by making only the union liable, not the members. This ignores the fact that the union funds belong to its members.

- - -

UNION SECURITY

The Hartley Bill flatly outlaws the so-called "closed" shop. It also places severe restrictions on the "union" shop.

The Taft Bill also prohibits the closed shop, but by a more indirect method, and it permits the union shop only under specified conditions. In addition, a pending amendment by Senators Ball and Byrd would outlaw all forms of union security.

Claim

The claim for these provisions is that the closed shop, and to some extent the union shop, deny the "right to work" of those seeking jobs and make union members subject to "coercion" of union "bosses."

Truth

The truth is that the closed shopand the union shop are merely devides for union security. They do not deny the right to work to anyone. They are intended solely to protect the union organization from being wrecked by hostile employers.

Any qualified worker can get a job in a plant under closed shop contract if he joins the union In many industries union workers refuse to work beside "free riders# who won't join the union.

These bills would attempt to impose the compulsory open shop upon American workers, a generation-long dream of the NAM.

Most employers with experience under closed shop contracts are now their greatest boosters. It gives them stability of labor force, better performance of contract conditions because the union can discipline wildcatters and higher grade of workmanship because the union, freed of the primary requirement of self-defense can devote more of its energies toward labor-maangement cooperation.

The highest labor standards, the greatest advances in labor-management cooperation and the best records in production have been attained in industries under union-security agreements. There are fewer strikes and less strife in such industries than in any others. A few examples are the International Ladies Garment Workers Union, the building trades, the glass contained industry (no strikes since 1885).

INDUSTRY-WIDE BARGAINING

The Hartley Bill wipes out industry-wide collective bargaining by a complex set of provisions. The Taft Bill permits it where employers have voluntarily associated themselves for collective bargaining. However, the pending Ball-Byrd-Smith-George Amendment to the Senate Bill prohibits the National Labor Relations Board from certifying a collective bargaining unit larger than a single employer or group of employers in the same metropolitan district or county.

CLAIM AND ANSWER

This ban on industry-wide bargaining is another pet NAM project. It is intended to protect the wage chiseler who wishes to compete unfairly with other firms in the same industry by cutting wages. The NAM says wages should be set to fit local conditions. This is an attempt to split America into hostile camps and to permit employers to set up "refugee" shops in economically submerged areas where wage rates are low.

Industry-wide bargaining has been one of the greatest uplifting factors toward the coming of age of American industry. It has proved to be a tremendous stabilizing factor for industrial peace. It has helped industry as well as labor. This kills the argument of its opponents that this type of bargaining places too much power in the hands of unions and enables them to tie up whole industries at a time. With very few exceptions, strikes have been eliminated when industry-wide bargaining has been established on a regional or national basis.

THE WAGNER ACT

The Hartley Bill virtually repeals the Wagner Act and distorts its whole purpose. It would also place the every-day activities of unions under strict Government regulation -- matters which up till now the union members have decided for themselves.

The Senate Bill re-writes the Wagner Act in many important respects, listing five major unfair labor practices by unions.

Thus labor's "Magna Carta" would be transformed under this bill into an instrument of possible oppression against labor unions and their members. It would regiment the trade union movement. It would impose a huge new bureaucracy over labor-management relations. It would interpose a whole set of red-tape Government regulations to snarl up relations between employers and their workers and make it impossible for such relations to be conducted on a simple and fair basis.

Those who screamed about wartime Government controls will have reason to scream even louder if this legislation becomes law because it would create a greater burden of Government controls than all the wartime regulations put together.

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INJUNCTIONS - Revival of Slave Labor

The Hartley Bill restores "Government by Injunction", making it possible for the Federal Government to obtain injunctions from the Federal courts to halt or restrain any threatened strike if the Government alleges it would tie up inter-State commerce. It virtually amends the Norris-LaGuardia Act to death by permitting private employers to obtain court injunctions, too, on allegations of breach of contract by the union.

The Senate Bill also provides for court injunctions in "national emergencies", a broad term subject to the widest latitude in interpretation by the Attorney General and the courts.

Claim

The attempted justification for this revival of Government injunction is that the Government should not be helpless to avert serious strikes which endanger the national health and safety.

Answer

The black history of the abuses of the labor unjunction by the courts in the past led Congress in 1932 to adopt the Norris-LaGuardia Act which forbids the courts to issue injunctions in labor disputes. Courts have been known even to forbid unions to provide food and shelter for starving and dispossessed strikers in an effort to starve them into submission. A typical example was the injunctior issued by Federal Judge Anderson in Indianapolis in the coal strike in 1919, an injunction applied for by Attorney General Palmer. The Norris-LaGuardia Act also outlawed the hated "yellow-dog" contract, which might be revived if this legislation is approved.

American workers will not work against their will for private employers. It is unjust and undemocratic to force them to do so by injunctive decrees. The public never suffers as much inconvenience in a strike as the strikers themselves. Slave labor has no place in America.

- - - -

Anti-Trust Laws

The Hartley Bill amends the Clayton Act by specifically providing that unions may be subject to prosecution under the Sherman Anti-Trust Act for any strikes or concerted action (conspiracy) to fix prices, allocate customers or restrict production, distrubution or competition or impose restrictions or conditions upon the purchase, sale or use of any product, materials, machine or equipment, etc.

Claim

Proponents claim that unions have been guilty of monopolistic practices which restrict production, boost prices and prevent more efficient production methods.

ANSWER

The Clayton Act held that the "labor of a human being is not a commodity or an article of commerce". Thereafter unions were exempted from prosecution under the anti-trust laws. This whole basic principle would be destroyed by the Hartley Bill. Under the guise of forbidding restrictive practices, it imposes such broad prohibitions that the Painters Union, for example, could be prosecuted and its officers fined and sent to jail if the union ordered its members not to use a paint spray machine which would subject them to the danger of lead poisoning. Thus practically all of the humane provisions established by unions to protect the health and safety of their members would be sacrificed at the altar of the God of Profit under this bill.

The courts have held that unions even now are subject to anti-trust prosecution if they conspire with employers to fix prices and restrict production or the use of any materials or equipment. But they have properly upheld the right of unions to protect their members from oppression, a right which this provision would destroy.

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HEALTH AND WELFARE FUNDS

The Hartley Bill outlaws employer contributions to any health, welfare or benefit fund, regardless of whether the fund is administered by the union alone or jointly with the employer or anyone else. No employer contributions toward such a fund can legally be made under this sweeping provision.

Claim

Proponents of this step cannot make any justifiable claim for it, relying entirely on the argument that they propose to "stop John L. Lewis" and Petrillo.

ANSWER

This is the most cruel provision in the bill, since it would straitjacket union attempts to provide decent minimum safety and health standards for American workers and to provide some protection for widows and children of those killed in industrial accidents. It would bar any effective progress toward adequate provision for families whose breadwinner is crippled by accidents or invalided by occupational diseases. It would prevent unions from setting up funds to carry members over serious period of unemployment, technological and otherwise.

These occupational hazards are a justified charge against the costs of production and should be insured against, at least in part, by employer contributions.

Unless American people want their coal smeared with the blood of miners, unless they have lost all regard for human values in our great industrial machine, they will reject this provision.

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THE CONSTRUCTIVE APPROACH

It has been repeatedly stated by such leading industrialists as Henry Kaiser, Henry Ford and Eric Johnston that the problem of labor relations is really a problem of human relations. This is the kind of problem that can't be solved merely by passing a law. The constructive approach -- the only effective approach -- is to develop greater confidence, trust and realization of mutuality of interest between labor and management.

Restrictive legislation will not serve this purpose. It will only promote further ill feeling and strife.

Labor must remain free if the free enterprise system is to endure. Once labor is chained and enslaved in America, the regimentation of business must follow.

This is made clearly evident in the Hatley and Taft Bills. They would reauire the Govenment to step in between the employer and the union representing his workers. They would prevent the necessary friendly and free interchange of facts and opinions which makes for good relations. They would establish a whole new code of rules and controls which would make wartime controls appear mild by contrast. Business is letting itself in for a terrible mess of Government regulation if it subscribes to this legislation and it becomes law.

Many of the provisions of this law would prove a hindrance, instead of a help to employers -- the decent employers. They have been drafted to protect the extremists among the reactionaries and, in that process, all the constructive progress made by labor and management in the last generation may be tossed overboard.

Collective bargaining is the only democratic method of resolving differences between employers and unions. Proponents of this legislation claim that the Wagner Act created an "imbalance" of power in the collective bargaining process, placing employers and the

public at the mercy of uhions. This is the cry of those who fear and dread equality of bargaining power, those who want to keep the unions weak, those who want to break them down to the local level. Today only one-third of the industrial workers of the nation have been organized into unions. Very few unions have achieved equaltiy of bargaining power as yet. While a union can tie up an industry effectively in many cases, it is forgotten that the employer also has the power to strike -- by shutting down his business. The lockout is employed frequently by employers in less drastic fashion by refusing to bargain in good faith with the union and refusing to make any offer of settlement of differences which could be accepted by the workers. The current telephone strike is a typical example.

The American Federation of Labor is convinced that the Wagner Act, as at present constituted, provides the only practical and democratic machinery for the settlement of labor-management disputes in a fair way. True, it has hot prevented strikes entirely, but it must be remembered that a strikeless nation is not a free nation. Strikes could not take place in Hitler's Germany or in Mussolini's Italy, but the people had to pay a terrific price. Strikes cannot take place in Soviet Russia today, but the American people certainly would not want that kind of government for themselves. Totalitarianism in any form is obnoxious to the American people, but if their representatives in Congress adopt the Taft-Hartley program they will allow it to get a foothold in this country.

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For Attaching

2519 Maryland Ave.,
Dallas, Texas.

Mr. William Green,
President, American Federation of Labor,
Washington, D. C.

RECEIVED
APR 28 1947

Dear Mr. Green:

Attached is some NAM propaganda regarding anti-labor laws.

Note that the newspaper roll is mentioned in connection with the anti-closed shop bill. These rolls were invented when newspapers fell into some disrepute during the Roosevelt administration. The Governor of Texas mentioned a state roll as his reason for signing the Texas anti-closed shop bill. I have never seen anyone who has been sent a questionnaire on one of these rolls.

Sincerely,

E. Roundstream

E. Roundstream

P.S.-The ad is from the Dallas Daily Times Herald of April 25.

Who wants the "Closed Shop"?

NOT THE PUBLIC . . . A 1947 nation-wide poll revealed that only one out of every ten people favors the closed shop—which requires every worker in a company to belong to a union BEFORE he can be hired.

NOT THE WORKERS . . . The same poll disclosed that only one out of every ten of the nation's manual workers favors the closed shop.

NOT EVEN THE MEMBERS OF UNIONS . . . According to this same study, among union members themselves, one out of every five favors the closed shop.

THE PUBLIC has learned by bitter experience that the closed shop, together with industry-wide bargaining, gives union leaders almost unlimited power—power that can stop the production of goods, shut off an essential public service, and put the health and comfort of hundreds of thousands of people in jeopardy.

MANUAL WORKERS as a whole know that the closed shop can deny them the right to work in their chosen jobs—unless they join the union.

UNION MEMBERS themselves have found that the closed shop means they must forfeit their individual freedom and follow union dictation, whether they agree with the rightness of such dictation or not!

IN THE PUBLIC INTEREST, as well as in the interest of both industry and labor, the National Association of Manufacturers believes that all forms of compulsory union membership should be prohibited because they are contrary to the American way of life.

[Write for your copy of "Americans Won't Stand for Monopolies," which includes the full text of NAM's program for industrial peace and national prosperity. Address: NAM, 14 West 49th Street, New York 20, N. Y.]

NATIONAL ASSOCIATION OF MANUFACTURERS

For a Better Tomorrow for Everybody

AN ANALYSIS OF SECTION 8 OF H. R. 3020 AS PASSED BY THE SENATE
OUTLAWING THE SO-CALLED CLOSED SHOP

The seven and one-half million members of the American Federation of Labor are divided up into approximately forty thousand local unions affiliated with the National and International Unions or directly affiliated with the American Federation of Labor.

Four million members of these forty thousand local unions are now working under union-shop contracts. In a number of instances union-shop contracts are entered into between the Employers' Associations and the National or International Unions covering the affiliated local unions on an industry, regional, or local basis.

Most of the local unions, have business representatives and maintain offices, which is the focal point for their membership. Day-rooms are maintained where unemployed members can congregate daily for the purpose of finding employment. The business representative acts as the counselor and employment agent.

The practices referred to herein would be wiped out completely by H. R. 3020 as passed by the Senate. Employers would be prohibited from making agreements that would permit this practice to continue. In its stead, provisions are made for union-shop contracts where anyone may be hired with a provision that they join the union in 30 days and where a majority of workers affected vote for same, under the supervision of a National Labor Relations Board. This, in itself, is a highly impractical feature, one that

cannot possibly be carried out and one which, if attempted, would bring a tremendous financial burden to bear upon the taxpayer, where today a union may enter into a union-shop agreement with a large number of employers thru the Employers' Association, under the terms of H. R. 3020 passed by the Senate, labor elections would be necessary in each shop.

It is inconceivable that a bureaucracy could be created that would adequately supervise the elections of the, literally, tens of thousands of contracts to be entered into. All of existing contracts would have to thus be supervised, and elections, in connection therewith, held.

The bill further provides that the union under a union-shop contract is compelled to take into its membership anyone the employer places to work on the same terms as the other members of the union were admitted to membership. This precludes the possibility of the union maintaining discipline by placing fines upon its membership for infractions of union rules, such as strike-breakers or lesser infractions. It opens the way for the strike-breaker, the undercover spy, and the Communist to infiltrate into labor unions to which he would otherwise be ineligible. One glaring inconsistency is that it provides that unions must take into membership Communists who are hired by employers who can in time aspire to office in the union, under the democratic procedure of the unions in the American Federation of Labor, and once in the position of an officer of the union such union's rights as a bargaining unit are nullified under the terms of this bill.

Dear Reaching

Washington State Federation of Labor

E. M. WESTON, *President* ★ MAIN 3978 ★ MAIN 9013

2800 FIRST AVENUE ... SEATTLE 1, WASHINGTON

April 24, 1947

RECEIVED
APR 28 1947

Mr. William Green, President
American Federation of Labor
A. F. of L. Building
Washington D. C.

Dear Brother Green:

Enclosed find copies of notice to all affiliates of the Washington State Federation of Labor on your request for help on the matters mentioned.

I hope our method helps to produce the result desired.

Best wishes.

Fraternally,
E. M. Weston

E. M. WESTON, President
WASHINGTON STATE FEDERATION
OF LABOR

EMW/ld
encl.

DISTRICT VICE-PRESIDENTS

DA M. PETERSON, 1st District . . . . . Box 126, Bellingham, Wash.
V. W. HOOPER, 2nd District . . . . . 930 W. Glass, Spokane 12, Wash.
MMETT HIGGINS, 3rd District . . . Room 515 Masonic Temple, Yakima, Wash.
ILLIAM R. SMITH, 4th District . . . . 410½ Main Street, Vancouver, Wash.
ONALD C. AHRENS, 5th District . . . . . Route 13, Box 967, Tacoma, Wash.
GEORGE D. EARLY, 6th District . . . . . Bell Street Terminal, Seattle 1, Wash.
MARTIN HUGHES, 7th District . . . . . Box 2233, Route 2, Edmonds, Wash.
E. W. HOLBROOK, 8th District . . . . . Box 248, Bremerton, Wash.
ELMER J. BROWN, 9th District . . . . . Labor Temple, Wenatchee, Wash.
HARRY S. GRAVES, 10th District . . . . . Labor Temple, Walla Walla, Wash.

Good luck and
I'm looking forward
to reading this letter out to
Ohio. F N

AMERICAN FEDERATION OF LABOR

Executive Council
President, William Green
Secretary-Treasurer, George Meany
A. F. of L. Building, Washington, D. C.

First Vice-President, William L. Hutcheson
Carpenters' Bldg., Indianapolis, Ind.
Second Vice-President, Harry Bridges
473 Lexington Ave., New York, N. Y.
Third Vice-President, Joseph N. Weber,
451 Alta Drive, Beverly Hills, Los Angeles, Calif.
Fourth Vice-President, G. M. Bugniazet,
1301 Fifteenth St., N. W., Washington, D. C.
Fifth Vice-President, Geo. M. Harrison,
Railway Clerks' Bldg., Cleveland, O.
Sixth Vice-President, Daniel J. Tobin,
222 East Michigan St., Indianapolis, Ind.
Seventh Vice-President, Harry C. Bates,
815 Fifteenth St., N. W., Washington, D. C.
Eighth Vice-President, W. D. Mahon,
12th Floor, 1013 Griswold St., Detroit 26, Mich.
Ninth Vice-President, Felix H. Knight,
418-419 Commerce Bldg., Kansas City, Mo.
Tenth Vice-President, W. C. Hushing,
Delaware at Twelfth Street, Indianapolis, Ind.
Eleventh Vice-President, W. C. Doherty,
Am. F. of L. Bldg., Washington, D. C.
Twelfth Vice-President, Daniel Tobin,
1113 Broadway, New York, N. Y.
Thirteenth Vice-President, John L. Lewis,
United Mine Workers' Bldg., Washington, D. C.

LONG DISTANCE TELEPHONE NATIONAL 3870-1-2-3-4
CABLE ADDRESS AFEL

Washington 1, D. C.

April 25, 1947

Mr. Phil Hannah, Secretary-Treasurer
State Federation of Labor
2647 Welsford Rd.
Columbus, Ohio

Dear Sir and Brother:

By direction of the Executive Council you are requested to come to Washington, D. C., at your earliest convenience, to remain for ten days or two weeks, in order that you may discuss with, and attempt to influence your U. S. Senators and Representatives against the anti-labor bills (H.R. 3020 and S. 1126) now being considered by the Congress.

The American Federation of Labor is campaigning against these bills and your presence here is required as a part of the program. Please advise immediately, by wire, regarding this matter.

If you can serve, upon your arrival here please contact the undersigned or W. C. Hushing, Chairman of the National Legislative Committee, in Room 607, American Federation of Labor Building, 901 Massachusetts Avenue, N. W., Washington, D. C.

In case the President or Secretary of your organization cannot attend, please designate one or two members of your Executive Board to serve in their place.

Fraternally yours,

Wm Green

President,
American Federation of Labor.

Secretary-Treasurer,
American Federation of Labor.

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6329 S. May St.
Chicago ., Illinois.
April 25, 1947.

4/29/47
Mr. Hushing

The Honorable C. Wayland Brooks
Senate Office Building
Washington, D.C.

Dear Senator:

You are requested to defeat the proposed anti-labor bills.

Millions of voters may have changed legislators last November because of reaction to the meat situation. However, they did not mean to sell their birthright for such a mess of pottage. After all, the majority of the population consists of workers, not employers, and they didn't change legislators for the purpose of crippling labor. Let me illustrate what these anti-labor bills mean.

1 Industry-wide collective bargaining helps the unions effectively to represent the interests of their members vis-a-vis employer groups, and is no less necessary than is the representation of the interests of the peoples of the various states by the United States government vis-a-vis other nations. Would the opponents of industry-wide collective bargaining by unions propose that each state separately negotiate with foreign nations? That would be no more absurd than collective bargaining--limited.

Only in a subjugated and dismembered nation, as in zoned Germany now, can victors require that foreign relations be carried out by the separate zoned areas. Similarly, to zone labor in its collective bargaining would be to proclaim, indisputably, that it, labor, has been subjugated and is being dismembered. That would be <u>not</u> freedom; that would be slavery--industrial slavery! (It required collaboration with the representatives of the poll-tax states to pass such an industrial slavery bill in the House of Representatives.)

2 The closed shop is a means of securing from all workers payment for the benefits of unionism, which improves conditions for all workers within the plant. Taxation is a means of securing from all inhabitants payment for the benefits and services which a government provides. Would those who would ban the closed shop likewise absolve from tax payment those inhabitants who do not care to pay their taxes though they enjoy governmental services for which other inhabitants pay? If workers may benefit as "free riders", not supporting though enjoying the benefits of unionism, is it more absurd for "free rider" inhabitants of a country to secure governmental services for which they do not pay?

Is it necessary to continue with such <u>reductio ad absurdum</u> of the other proposals?

"However the battle is ended;
Though proudly the victor comes
With fluttering flags and prancing nags
And echoing roll of drums,
Still truth proclaims this motto
In letters of living sight:
'No question is ever settled
Until it is settled right.'"

Yours truly,

Albert Bofman

Albert Bofman.

cc: Senator Scott W Lucas;
Representatives Fred E Busbey,
William G. Stratton;
Senate Labor and Public Welfare Comm.;
House Education and Labor Committee;
Pres. Truman;
Individual members of Senate Labor and
Public Welfare Committee;
Others.

RECEIVED APR 29 1947

Rockwell Road
Bethel, Connecticut
April 26, 1947

Mr Shamberg

Hon. Brien McMahon, United States Senator
Senate Office Building
Washington, D. C.

RECEIVED
APR 29 1947

COPY

Dear Senator McMahon:

A positive conviction of repentance impels this personal letter for your consideration.

According to announcement through the Associated Press, both the Hartley Bill recently passed by the House and the Bill to be presented in the Senate by Senator Ball contain provisions to out-law the so called "closed shop".

As therefor repentant of the assumption that in the last Congressional election a majority vote, wherein the balance of power for choice of representatives in Congress was exercised by the rank and file of organized labor, and that said group knew what it wanted in the matter of representation and same was delivered; that no further exercise of supplication or appeal would be needed to secure the grade of legislation that would be satisfactory to the above named group; that resolve to cease and desist from appealing to any of the representatives, so chosen, in the important matter of framing laws affecting the national welfare was a conscientious motive.

Of all the above am repentant and feel somewhat guilty of procrastination, especially as I have heard and read some comments upon the closed shop issue, and had also assumed that the pro and con of that question would eventually become a dead issue.

It is now with surprise that I read the announcement in the Associated Press that the proponents for the ban on the closed shop are assured of majority Congressional support for such legislation and feel justified in submitting this protest against such a commitment.

As also appealing to you for your opposition to the proposed legislation.

Such a Bill if enacted into law would in my opinion, for all who retain sound and unshakable faith in due process of law, appear as a fiasco of bureaucracy, simply because an organization of labor under the commitments contained therein could not exist; any member of a union who believes in joining, working under rules and regulations and paying dues to support such an organization would immediately recognize the futility of such membership and support, if another person works at the same occupation or profession in the same plant, corporation, institution et cetera and refuses to join or otherwise support such an organization

. Therefor such a Bill virtually outlaws organization of any sort.

Furthermore, if such legislation is passed under the specious assumption that a person should enjoy the freedom to work when, where and under whatever conditions he or she elects, what guarantee have we that the same directives will not be brought to bear against any other organization whether such organization be religious, fraternal or in any other way beneficial; all of which now enjoy the principle of the closed shop.

If, however, organizations industrial in nature are denied by legislative fiat the rights of the closed shop and o other organizations are not, we will be subjected to not only class legislation which is evil enough in itself, but also to government that is repressive and oppressive in every since of the term.

It is a reluctant suspicion that there are enemies of life, liberty and the pursuit of happiness who would applaud with sardonic satisfaction the passage of legislation by the Congress of the Unites States which would place pseudo property rights in such promenence and which would evoke unrest the like of which civilized society has never known. I also believe that many who would so vote and otherwise concur in such action would be among the first to suffer remorse therefor.

Convinced that a great responsibility is balanced upon your decision, I am with great respect

Sincerely yours

Benjamin B. Peck.

Duplicate sent to Senator Raymond E. Baldwin
Copies to
Mr. William Green, President of the American Federation of Labor
Mr. Timothy M. Collins, President, Connecticut Federation of Labor
Mr. Joseph M. Rourke, Secretary-Treasurer, Connecticut Federation of Labor

Mr. Peck

Vice-President, Price, Utah
Vice-President, 451 South 1st West, Logan, Utah
dent, 1078 Wall Avenue, Ogden, Utah
-President, 1013 West Center St., Provo, Utah
[illegible] 387 E. 1st N., Brigham City

RECEIVED
APR 28 1947

April 26, 1947
2925 McNair Ave.
St. Louis, 18, Mo.

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Mr. Hutcheson

RECEIVED
APR 29 1947

April 26, 1947
2925 Hogan Ave.
St. Louis, 18, Mo.

Mr. William Green
Washington D. C.

I being a member of the A.F.of L. for the past twenty years have enjoyed a decent living. But now I am very much concerened about the anti-labor bills now pending. Looking around me in my own local union, I Find the majority of the members do not follow the voting of their Congressmen and Senators on labor legislation; and other bills benefiting the working men. Then there is some that watch the vote, but forget all about it on election day. It seemed a shame to have so many good friends of labor go down in defeat, as they have in the past because members of the union just----- "Didn't know the score," on the men up for election.

To cope with this situation I would like to propose the following plan----:

1. A monthly bulletin be printed and sent to each State Federation informing them how its Senators and Congressmen vote on bills that are important to labor.
2. The State Federation in return should reprint this bulletin and send one to each local union in the State where it should be read before its members at meeting. It should then be placed in the office on the bulletin board for furthur reference.

For example my local union is in St. Louis. Our members all vote in the 11th, 12th, and 13th districts, so we are in-

-terested in and can only vote for Congressmen Carson, Blackwell, or Ploeser and Senators Kem, and Donnell of Missouri. Therefore we should have thier activities constantly before us. In addition a term summary just before election day.

I hope that this or some similar plan can be put into effect. I feel sure that our 7,000,000 members, plus their families and friends can make themselves heard from.

Sincerly yours
Roy H. Kraemer
2925 McNair
St. Louis, Mo.
Membership #115831
Local Union #36
Sheet Metal Workers International Assn.

FEDERATION of LABOR OF BUFFALO AND VICINITY

310 WHITE BUILDING Cleveland 0375 BUFFALO, NEW YORK

ROBERT A. SMITH, President
GEORGE STURGES, Secretary
OSCAR O. CARLSON, Fin. Secretary

Affiliated with
American Federation of Labor
New York State Federation of Labor

April 28, 1947

TO THE AMERICAN FEDERATION
OF LABOR MEMBERS:

Dear Member:-

The Federation of Labor of Buffalo and Vicinity Committee on current anti-labor legislation has been actively engaged in the very important task of combating this harmful program.

The Committee has now reached a point where your support is very necessary if we are to achieve 100% unity of purpose. You, personally, as an American Federation of Labor member, must help the Buffalo Federation of Labor to do a job.

We are depending on you to immediately write a letter, in your own handwriting, to Senator Robert A. Taft, Chairman, Senate Labor Committee and/or to your two United States Senators. Address each letter to:

Senator Robert F. Wagner, Senate Office Building, Washington, D. C.

Senator Irving M. Ives, Senate Office Building, Washington, D. C.

Tell them in your own words your sentiments concerning the proposed anti-labor legislation. We believe your thoughts will have a great effect upon Congress.

Please give this matter your immediate attention - it is urgent!

Fraternally yours,

George Sturges

GEORGE STURGES, Chairman
SPECIAL LEGISLATIVE COMMITTEE

GS:KF

RECEIVED MAY 8 - 1947

W. L. LOWE, First Vice-President, 2270 Butler Ave., Ogden, Utah
L. F. ANDERSON, Second Vice-President, 1194 [illegible] South St., Salt Lake City
JOHN McKRAE, Third Vice-President, 658 Wilson Ave., Salt Lake City
HERMAN BELL, Fourth Vice-President, R. F. D. No. 2, Ogden, Utah
R. S. ROBERTS, Fifth Vice-President, 151 South 2nd East, Salt Lake City
FARRELL LILJENQUIST, Sixth Vice-President, 602 E. 5th North, Provo, Utah

JOHN W. BOLIEK, [illegible] Vice-President, Price, Utah
KLEON W. JOHNSON, Eighth Vice-President, 451 South 1st West, Tremonton, Utah
P. W. KIRBY, Ninth Vice-President, 2278 Wall Avenue, Ogden, Utah
E. W. ANDERSON, Tenth Vice-President, 1012 West Center St., Provo, Utah
J. RYDALE PETERSEN, Eleventh Vice-President, 387 E. 1st N., Brigham City
WILLIAM WEBB, Twelfth Vice-President, Davis Bldg., Utah

Utah State Federation of Labor

151 South 2nd East, Salt Lake City, Utah

RECEIVED
APR 28 1947

FULLMER H. LATTER, President
2562 Stratford Drive,
Salt Lake City, Utah

J. R. WILSON, Secretary-Treasurer
151 Carlton Avenue,
Salt Lake City, Utah

April 25, 1947

Mr. Wm. M. Green, President,
American Federation of Labor,
A. F. of L. Building,
Washington, D. C.

Dear Sir and Brother:

Enclosed herewith is copy of letter to Senator Taft which is self explanatory.

Fraternally yours,

Fullmer H. Latter, President,
Utah State Federation of Labor

(Encl)
FHL/pmb

OFFICE EMPLOYES INT'L. UNION 31

April 25, 1947

Hon. Robt. A. Taft,
Chairman, Senate Committee
on Labor and Public Welfare,
Senate Office Building,
Washington, D. C.

Dear Senator Taft:

I am compelled, in view of the press releases quoting you, to call your attention to a conference you held at the Newhouse Hotel in Salt Lake City with representatives of organized labor on your recent visit to this state.

At that conference before many witnesses I, myself, posed the question to you as to whether or not you believed in the union shop. In answer to that question you asked me whether or not I meant the closed shop. Thereupon I stated to you that we would deal with it as the closed shop. You then said "Our law firm in Ohio representing the Street Railway Company in negotiations of a contract with the Union has a closed shop clause in it, and the management requested that it remain in the contract; that it had proved satisfactory, and therefore was not objectionable." You further stated that you did not believe that it was advisable to legislate against the closed shop and that you would be opposed to such procedure.

In view of the above I have been somewhat amazed at your recent position in connection with this matter, and hope that you will see fit to oppose the legislation presently being considered by the United States Senate to outlaw the closed shop.

Very truly yours,

Fullmer H. Latter, President,
Utah State Federation of Labor

FHL/pmb

AIR MAIL ALL WEST OF THE MISSISSIPPI

STATE FEDERATIONS Presidents and Secretaries	CENTRAL LABOR UNIONS Presidents
Alabama	Birmingham
Arkansas	Little Rock
California	San Francisco - Los Angeles
Connecticut	Danbury - Stamford
Delaware	Wilmington
Florida	Jacksonville
Illinois	Chicago - Springfield
Indiana	Fort Wayne - Indianapolis
Iowa	Des Moines
Kansas	
Kentucky	Louisville
Maryland	Baltimore - Washington
Massachusetts	Boston - Worcester
Michigan	Detroit - Muskegon
Minnesota	Duluth - Minneapolis and Hennepin Co
	St. Paul
Missouri	St. Louis - Kansas City
Nebraska	Omaha
New Jersey	Newark
New York	New York - Buffalo
Ohio	Cleveland - Cincinnati
Oklahoma	Oklahoma City
Pennsylvania	Philadelphia - Pittsburgh
Rhode Island	
South Carolina	
Texas	
Tennessee	
Virginia	Richmond
West Virginia	
Wisconsin	Milwaukee

April 25, 1947

Mr. Thomas A. Murray, President
State Federation of Labor
265 W. 14th Street, Rm. 1102
New York 11, N. Y.

Dear Sir and Brother:

By direction of the Executive Council you are requested to come to Washington, D. C., at your earliest convenience, to remain for ten days or two weeks, in order that you may discuss with, and attempt to influence your U. S. Senators and Representatives against the anti-labor bills (H.R. 3020 and S. 1126) now being considered by the Congress.

The American Federation of Labor is campaigning against these bills and your presence here is required as a part of the program. Please advise immediately, by wire, regarding this matter.

If you can serve, upon your arrival here please contact the undersigned or W. C. Hushing, Chairman of the National Legislative Committee, in Room 607, American Federation of Labor Building, 901 Massachusetts Avenue, N. W., Washington, D. C.

In case the President or Secretary of your organization cannot attend, please designate one or two members of your Executive Board to serve in their place.

Fraternally yours,

President,
American Federation of Labor.

President,
American Federation of Labor.

Secretary-Treasurer,
American Federation of Labor.

Secretary-Treasurer,
American Federation of Labor.

em
oeiu#2
oeiu#2 Wes & Frank Coleman

April 25, 1947

Mr. C. F. Preller, President
Central Labor Union
720 5th St., N. W.
Washington, D. C.

Dear Sir and Brother:

By direction of the Executive Council you are requested to make yourself available for ten days or two weeks in order that you may discuss with, and attempt to influence U. S. Senators and Representatives against the anti-labor bills (H.R. 3020 and S. 1126) now being considered by the Congress.

The American Federation of Labor is campaigning against these bills and your assistance is required as a part of the program. Please advise immediately regarding this matter.

If you can serve, please contact the undersigned or W. C. Hushing, Chairman of the National Legislative Committee, Room 607, American Federation of Labor Building.

In case the President or Secretary of your organization cannot attend, please designate one or two members of your Executive Board to serve in their place.

Fraternally yours,

President,
American Federation of Labor.

Secretary-Treasurer,
American Federation of Labor.

em
oeiu#2

Same letter to Frank Coleman

CLASS OF SERVICE

CLASS OF SERVICE

This is a full-rate Telegram or Cablegram unless its deferred character is indicated by a suitable symbol above or preceding the address.

WESTERN UNION

JOSEPH L. EGAN
PRESIDENT

1201

(09)

Mr Hushing

SYMBOLS
DL = Day Letter
NL = Night Letter
LC = Deferred Cable
NLT = Cable Night Letter
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1947 APR 26 PM 1 10

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WV63 DL PD=NEWYORK NY 26 1228P

1947 APR 26 PM 12 42

WILLIAM GREEN PRES=

A F OF L=

RECEIVED
APR 26 1947

THE MEMBERSHIP OF PAPERHANGERS LOCAL UNION 490 NEW YORK CITY RESPECTFULLY URGE THAT YOU DO EVERYTHING IN YOUR POWER TO DEFEAT THE PROPOSED ANTI LABOR LEGISLATION=

PAPERHANGERS LOCAL UNION 490 853 BROADWAY N Y...

490 490 853.

THE COMPANY WILL APPRECIATE SUGGESTIONS FROM ITS PATRONS CONCERNING ITS SERVICE

Ich bin bereit zu sein
was ich bin

G

CLASS OF SERVICE

CLASS OF SERVICE

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WESTERN UNION

JOSEPH L. EGAN
PRESIDENT

(15)

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WV168 PD=DESMOINES IOWA 28 209P 1947 APR 28 PM 4 16

WILLIAM GREEN PRES=

AMERICAN FEDERAL OF LABOR AF OF L BLDG:

=WILL ARRIVE IN WASHINGTON SUNDAY MAY 4=

A A COUCH PRES IOWA STATE FEDERAL OF LABOR.

May 4

RECEIVED
APR 28 1947

4.

RECEIVED
APR 28 1947

THE COMPANY WILL APPRECIATE SUGGESTIONS FROM ITS PATRONS CONCERNING ITS SERVICE

CLASS OF SERVICE

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WESTERN UNION

1947 APR 28 PM

JOSEPH L. EGAN
PRESIDENT

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IWV188 PD= LOUISVILLE KY 28 248P

WILLIAM GREEN AND GEORGE MEANY, AMERICAN FEDERATION

OF LABOR=A F OF L BLDG=

WILL COMPLY WITH YOUR REQUEST REGARDING LOBBYING EXPECT

TO ARRIVE WASHINGTON THURSDAY AFTERNOON MAY 1ST WILL

CONTACT YOU=

EDWARD H WEYLER.

1.

THE COMPANY WILL APPRECIATE SUGGESTIONS FROM ITS PATRONS CONCERNING ITS SERVICE

Labor Legis

M E M O R A N D U M

To: Secretary-Treasurer Meany
From: W. C. Hushing
Date: April 28, 1947

A. F. of L. Dinner for Judge Padway to explain pending anti-labor bills to all Washington Legislative Representatives of the American Federation of Labor and Railroad Brotherhoods will be held at Hotel Hamilton, Chantilly Room, 7:00 p.m., Tuesday night, April 29, 1947.

I. C. Wolstad
I. C. Wolstad
Secretary-Treasurer

ICW/p

[illegible]

Virginia State Federation of Labor

[illegible]

April 20, 1949

[illegible]

City, Va. Manassas,
1009 Cedar Street, Alexandria, Va.

Temperance Avenue,
Alexandria, Va.

John F. Tunstall
616 10th St., NW., Charlottesville, Va.

J. D. Byrd,
518 Rose Ave., Clifton Forge, Va.

W. F. Morton,
P. O. Box 468, Norton, Va.

R. B. Kennedy,
304 Church St., Madison Heights,
Lynchburg, Va.

J. L. Burns, Jr.
516 Carlisle Ave., Hampton, Va.

A. L. Burrows,
911 E. Freemason St., Norfolk 10, Va.

E. M. Brown,
P. O. Box 493, Portsmouth, Va.

L. G. Lane,
3301 Cowland Ave., Richmond 21, Va.

A. E. Wynne,
P. O. Box 912, Roanoke, Va.

E. Wayne Lyons,
P. O. Box 171, Winchester, Va.

Owen Agnew,
1514 W. 47th St., Norfolk 8, Va.

McKinnon Powell,
347 Federal St., Pittsburg, Va.

A. J. Monroe,
1719 W. Cary St., Richmond 20, Va.

William Glatt,
325 New Jersey Ave., NW.,
Washington 1, D. C.

Horace W. Sharp
Chairman State Legislative Committee
Phone Portsmouth 3687-W
1228 Holladay Street Portsmouth, Va.

Paul Askew
Chairman National Legislative Committee
406 Portlock Bldg., Norfolk, Va.

Pay Your Poll Tax, Register and Qualify to Vote — This Is Your Duty as a Citizen of a Democratic Country.

RECEIVED
APR 22 1949

Mr. William Green, President,
American Federation of Labor,
Washington, D. C.

Dear Sir and Brother,

In reply to your recent communication regarding assigning someone to Washington to attempt to influence our U. S. Senators against labor bills, this is to advise that Brother Paul Askew, National Legislative Chairman, and Brother H. W. Sharp, State Legislative Chairman, have been assigned to handle this matter.

They will arrive in Washington tonight and will report to Mr. Dushing's office Tuesday, April 26th.

With best wishes, I remain

Fraternally yours,

I. C. Welsted

I. C. Welsted
Secretary--treasurer

ICW/p

FEDERATION of LABOR OF BUFFALO AND VICINITY

310 WHITE BUILDING Cleveland 0375 BUFFALO, NEW YORK

ROBERT A. SMITH, Presid.
GEORGE STURGES, Secretary
OSCAR O. CARLSON, Fin

Mr Bluhm

AMERICAN FEDERATION of LABOR

Affiliated with
American Federation of Labor
New York State Federation of Labor

April 28, 1947

RECEIVED
MAY 8 1947

TO THE AMERICAN FEDERATION
OF LABOR MEMBERS:

Dear Member -

The Federation of Labor of Buffalo and Vicinity Committee on current anti-labor legislation has been actively engaged in the very important task of combating this harmful program.

The Committee has now reached a point where your support is very necessary if we are to achieve 100% unity of purpose. You, personally, as an American Federation of Labor member, must help the Buffalo Federation of Labor to do a job.

We are depending on you to immediately write a letter, in your own handwriting, to Senator Robert A. Taft, Chairman, Senate Labor Committee and/or to your two United States Senators. Address each letter to:

Senator Robert F. Wagner, Senate Office Building, Washington, D. C.

Senator Irving M. Ives, Senate Office Building, Washington, D. C.

Tell them in your own words your sentiments concerning the proposed anti-labor legislation. We believe your thoughts will have a great effect upon Congress.

Please give this matter your immediate attention - it is urgent!

Fraternally yours,

George Sturges

GEORGE STURGES, Chairman
SPECIAL LEGISLATIVE COMMITTEE

GS:KF

WESTERN UNION

(15)

SYMBOLS
DL = Day Letter
NL = Night Letter
LC = Deferred Cable
NLT = Cable Night Letter
Ship Radiogram

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PD 1 EXTRA=MILWAUKEE WIS 28 413P

WILLIAM GREEN, PRESIDENT AMERICAN FEDERATION OF LABOR=

A F OF L BLDG WASHDC= 901 Mass Ave NW

AS PER YOUR REQUEST OF APRIL 25 WITH REFERENCE TO NECESSARY LEGISLATIVE WORK, WILL ARRIVE IN WASHINGTON, D.C. WEDNESDAY, APRIL 30TH=

GEORGE A HABERMAN PRESIDENT WISCONSIN STATE FEDERATION OF LABOR.

RECEIVED
APR 29 1947

25 30.

THE COMPANY WILL APPRECIATE SUGGESTIONS FROM ITS PATRONS CONCERNING ITS SERVICE

WESTERN
UNION

WESTERN UNION

JOSEPH L. EGAN
PRESIDENT

NL (17)

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1947 APR 28 PM 2 19

WV1 21 PD=BOSTON MASS 28 146P

PRESIDENT WILLIAM GREEN AMERICAN FEDERATION OF LABOR=

AF OF L BLDG 901 MASS AVE=

Mr Husing

LEAVING BOSTON THIS AFTERNOON. WILL REPORT TO MR HUSING TOMORROW MORNING=

KENNETH J KELLEY SECTY TREASURER MASSACHUSETTS STATE FEDERATION OF LABOR.

RECEIVED APR 28 1947

THE COMPANY WILL APPRECIATE SUGGESTIONS FROM ITS PATRONS CONCERNING ITS SERVICE

(27)

WESTERN UNION

1201

1947 APR 29 AM 9 28

JOSEPH L. EGAN
PRESIDENT

SYMBOLS

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Ship Radiogram

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'18 PD=CHARLESTON K CO WVIR 29 903A

LLIAM GREEN PRES=

AMERICAN FEDERATION OF LABOR AF OF L BLDG=

-L ARRIVE IN WASHINGTON THURSDAY MORNING MAY 1ST. HAMILTON

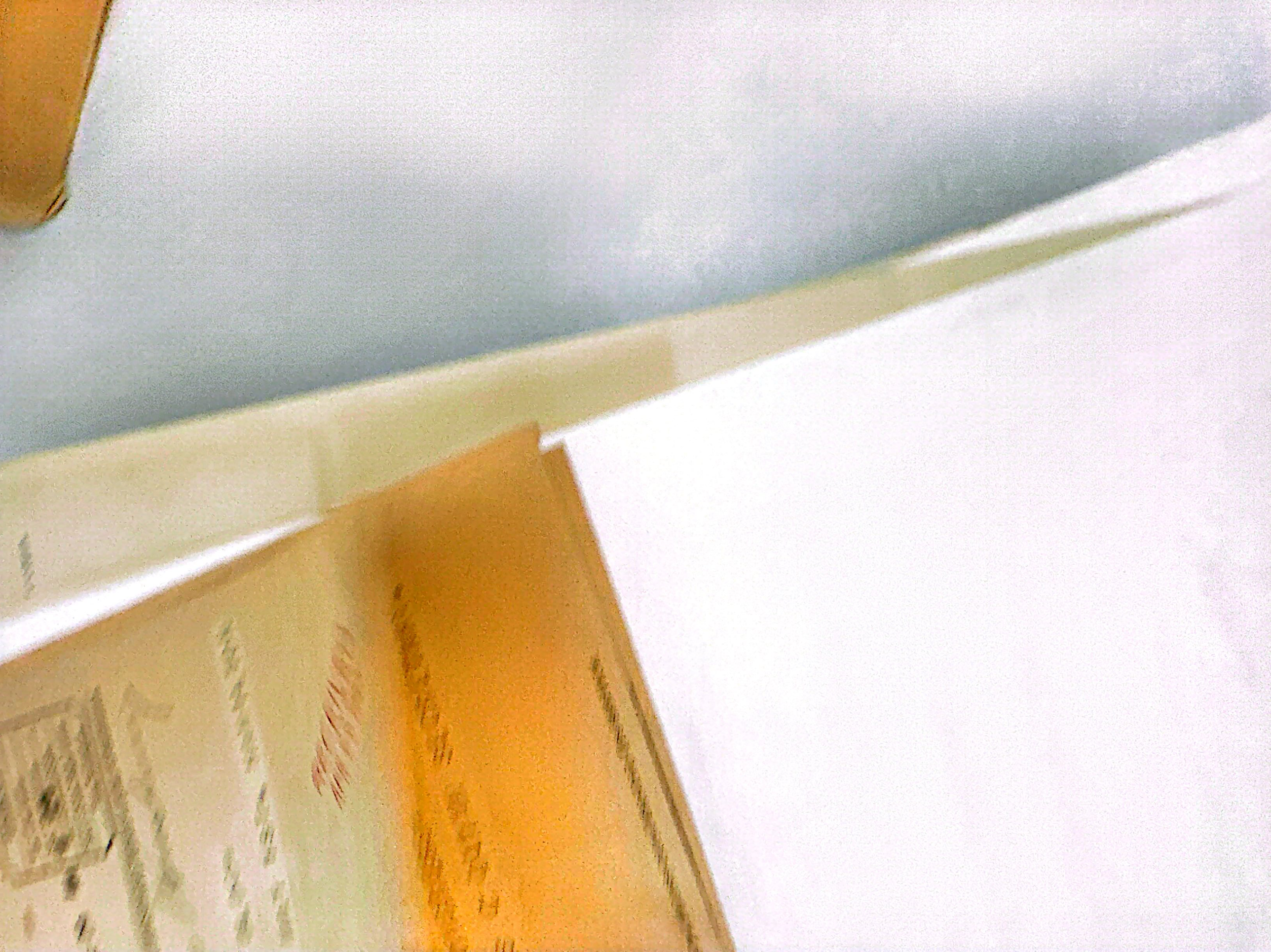
)T EL=

VOLNEY ANDREWS.

RECEIVED
APR 29 1947

1.

THE COMPANY WILL APPRECIATE SUGGESTIONS FROM ITS PATRONS CONCERNING ITS SERVICE



"Labor is Organized to be the great conqueror, standing and battling at various points, to share the progress battles"

Fort Wayne Federation of Labor

This is Union Made Paper—In Favor

Meets Second and Fourth Monday Evenings
at Federation Hall, 309 West Berry Street

FORT WAYNE, INDIANA

April 28, 1947

RECEIVED
APR 30 1947

Mr. Wm. Green, President
American Federation of Labor
A. F. of L. Building
Washington 1, D. C.

Dear Sir and Brother:-

Brother E. Robert Leach, President of the Fort Wayne Federation of Labor has contacted me regarding your request that he be present in Washington for a few days to influence our Representatives against anti-labor bills.

Since it is impossible for Brother Leach to be present due to many other pressing engagements he has at this time, we have taken the liberty of sending Brother A. V. Landes, Business Representative of Local No. 423 of the Amalgamated Meat Cutters and Butcher Workmen of North America, who we feel, is well qualified to assist you in this program.

Brother Landes will arrive in Washington Monday, May 5th.

Hoping this meets with your approval and with best wishes, I remain

May 3

Fraternally yours,

Wm. J. Avery

Wm. J. Avery
Secretary

WJA/t

Copy

MINNESOTA STATE FEDERATION OF LABOR

R. A. Olson, President
Labor Temple, St. Paul

Geo. W. Lawson, Sec.-Treas.
Labor Temple, St. Paul

April 29, 1947

Mr. William Green, President
American Federation of Labor
Washington 1, D. C.

Dear Sir and Brother:

Replying to your favor of the 25th in which you request on behalf of the Executive Council that President Olson and I come to Washington for the purpose of contacting the members of Congress from Minnesota regarding the anti-labor bills now before Congress, I beg to advise you that we have just completed our legislative session and commitments which we are unable to change make it impossible for us to leave St. Paul until Thursday of this week. We will therefore arrive in Washington Friday afternoon, May 2nd.

Please have reservations made for us at the Hamilton Hotel.

We expect to remain only long enough to carry out your wishes in contacting our members of Congress, owing to the amount of work confronting us with reference to our Legislative session.

In this connection, I am enclosing copies of two important measures affecting labor passed by the Legislature and signed by the Governor. I know you will be interested in reading them and that you will appreciate we will have to develop a program to meet court tests at least in the secondary boycott act.

With kindest personal regards, I am

Fraternally yours,

/s/ George W. Lawson

Secretary

AFFILIATED WITH

AMERICAN FEDERATION OF LABOR — FLORIDA FEDERATION OF LABOR

CENTRAL LABOR UNION

MEETS SECOND AND FOURTH WEDNESDAY

LABOR TEMPLE - 808 MAIN STREET
JACKSONVILLE 2, FLORIDA

April 29, 1947.

Mr. W. C. Hushing,
Chairman of the National
Legislative Committee,
Room 607,
American Federation of Labor Bldg.,
901 Massachusetts Ave., N. W.,
Washington, D. C.

Dear Sir and Brother:

This will introduce Mr. C.G. Smith, who is authorized to represent the Jacksonville, Florida, Central Labor Union in any capacity you may see fit with reference to labor legislation being considered by the Congress.

Fraternally yours,

CENTRAL LABOR UNION OF
JACKSONVILLE, FLORIDA

By Marie Broetzman
Marie Broetzman
Secretary.

AMERICAN FEDERATION OF LABOR

Executive Council
President, WILLIAM GREEN
Secretary-Treasurer, GEORGE MEANY
A. F. of L. Building, Washington, D. C.

First Vice-President, WILLIAM L. HUTCHESON,
Carpenters' Bldg., Indianapolis, Ind.
Second Vice-President, MATTHEW WOLL,
470 Lexington Ave., New York, N. Y.
Third Vice-President, JOSEPH N. WEBER,
925 Alta Drive, Beverly Hills, Los Angeles, Calif.
Fourth Vice-President, G. M. BUGNIAZET,
1200 Fifteenth St., N. W., Washington, D. C.
Fifth Vice-President, GEO. M. HARRISON,
Railway Clerks' Bldg., Cincinnati, O.
Sixth Vice-President, DANIEL J. TOBIN,
222 East Michigan St., Indianapolis, Ind.
Seventh Vice-President, HARRY C. BATES,
815 Fifteenth St., N. W., Washington, D. C.
Eighth Vice-President, W. D. MAHON,
Post Office Box 617, Hollywood, Fla.
Ninth Vice-President, FELIX H. KNIGHT,
4262 Westwood Road, Kansas City 2, Mo.
Tenth Vice-President, W. C. BRADLEY,
Delaware at Twelfth Street, Indianapolis, Ind.
Eleventh Vice-President, W. C. DOHERTY,
901 A. F. of L. Bldg., Washington, D. C.
Twelfth Vice-President, DAVID DUBINSKY,
1710 Broadway, New York, N. Y.
Thirteenth Vice-President, JOHN L. LEWIS,
United Mine Workers' Bldg., Washington, D. C.

AMERICAN FEDERATION OF LABOR
Org'd Nov. 15, 1881

LONG DISTANCE TELEPHONE NATIONAL 9870-1-2-3-4
CABLE ADDRESS AFEL.

Washington 1, D. C. April 29, 1947.

To the Officers of National and International Unions,
State Federations of Labor, City Central Bodies and
Directly Affiliated Local Unions.

Dear Sirs and Brothers:

The Executive Council of the American Federation of Labor at its recent meeting in this city gave special consideration to the drive which is being made against organized labor through the attempt to enact anti-labor legislation. This drive in state legislatures and in the Congress of the United States is being given the full support of the National Association of Manufacturers and other anti-labor groups and organizations.

The vicious anti-labor bill sponsored by Congressman Hartley passed the House of Representatives by an overwhelming majority. It seems indeed inconceivable that Congress would pass such a measure. It is destructive of the rights as well as the individual and collective freedom of the workers throughout the nation.

It revives government by injunction; makes some strikes illegal; provides for the institution of damage suits against unions for alleged violation of contract; prohibits secondary boycotts; prohibits foremen from belonging to unions; provides for the destruction of closed-shop agreements and industry-wide bargaining; outlaws joint welfare funds; drastically changes the United States Conciliation Service; provides for drastic amendments to the National Labor Relations Act; and empowers the President to seize industries essential to the public welfare, as the mines were seized under War Powers.

An analysis of this anti-labor measure shows that it will be very difficult for trade unions to function at all under the provisions of this reprehensible anti-labor legislation.

In an effort to combat this anti-labor legislation the Executive Council decided to launch a nation-wide newspaper and radio campaign. This campaign has been launched. A full-page advertisement appeared in newspapers in the cities through-

out the nation on Monday, April 28th. This will be continued for some length of time. Arrangements have been made for the launching of a radio campaign. All of this is designed to educate and acquaint the people of the nation with the dangers which threaten the basic freedom and liberty of the workers of the nation, as well as all classes of people, through the enactment of anti-labor legislation.

The Executive Council authorized the expenditure of substantial sums of money in this newspaper publicity and radio campaign. Through this method we will carry on our fight in a vigorous, militant and aggressive way against this slave legislation which is being enacted by the Congress of the United States.

State Federations of Labor, Central Labor Unions and all other organized units of the American Federation of Labor can help in a most valuable way in this campaign. You can help by having the individual members of organized labor and their friends in the respective communities write their United States Senators and Members of the House of Representatives protesting the enactment of this legislation and calling upon them to vote against it. Perhaps you can supplement this by having petitions signed and forwarded to the Members of the House and Senate.

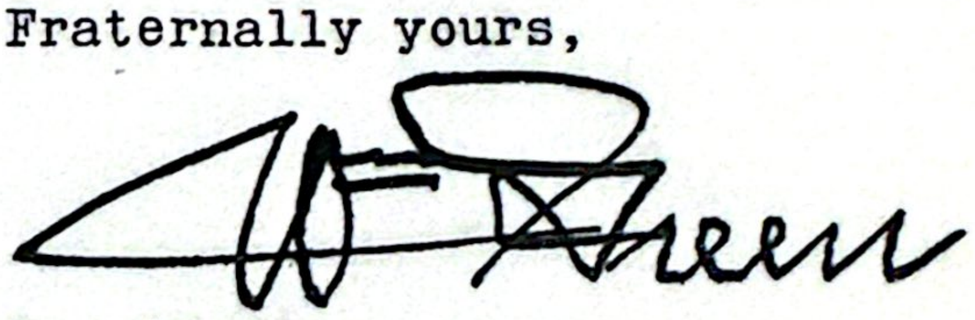
Our enemies have organized against us and are carrying on a vigorous campaign in behalf of this anti-labor legislation.

We, too, must organize in opposition to this fight which is being made against our very existence.

This is your fight; the fight of all who cherish the principles of freedom and democracy. In complying with the urgent request we are herewith making, you will be fighting for yourselves, for the enjoyment of liberty for yourselves and for your families.

Because of the seriousness of the situation we respectfully urge all the members of organized labor to do their part by responding to the appeal we have herein made to communicate with their representatives in the House and Senate of the United States immediately.

Fraternally yours,



President,
American Federation of Labor

Secretary-Treasurer,
American Federation of Labor

WESTERN UNION

1201

1947 APR 29 PM 12

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LC = Deferred Cable
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Ship Radiogram

JOSEPH L. EGAN
PRESIDENT

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1 PD= INDIANAPOLIS IND 29 1022A

ESIDENT WILLIAM GREEN, AMERICAN FEDERATION OF LADOR=

AF OF L BLDG=

Mr Lenahan

LL ARRIVE WEDNESDAY. CARL UNABLE TO COME FOR A DAY OR SO.
WILL CONTACT YOU UPON ARRIVAL=.

JOHN ACKER SECY TREAS INDIANA STATE FEDERATION
OF LABOR.

RL
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RECEIVED
APR 29 1947

THE COMPANY WILL APPRECIATE SUGGESTIONS FROM ITS PATRONS CONCERNING ITS SERVICE

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WESTERN UNION

(32)..

A. N. WILLIAMS
PRESIDENT

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...60 PD=LANSING MICH 29 619P

1947 APR 29 PM 6 38

RECEIVED
APR 30 1947

...LLIAM GREEN PRESIDENT=

AMERICAN FEDERATION OF LABOR AFL BLDG WASHDC=

...CE PRESIDENT G BURTON MCLAUGHLIN REPRESENTING MICHIGAN
...DERATION OF LABOR WILL REPORT TO AFL WASHINGTON OFFICE
...DNESDAY AS REQUESTED STOP PLEASE ARRANGE FOR ROOM AT HOTEL
...MILTON=

GEORGE W DEAN PRESIDENT MICHIGAN FEDERATION OF LABOR
306 BAUCH BUILDING.

...06.

THE COMPANY WILL APPRECIATE SUGGESTIONS FROM ITS PATRONS CONCERNING ITS SERVICE

Mr Meaning

WESTERN UNION

1201

A. N. WILLIAMS
PRESIDENT

SYMBOLS
DL = Day Letter
NL = Night Letter
LC = Deferred Cable
NLT = Cable Night Letter
Ship Radiogram

The filing time shown in the date line on telegrams and day letters is STANDARD TIME at point of origin. Time of receipt is STANDARD TIME at point of destination

QA30

Q.CMA959 NL PD=COLUMBIA SOCAR 30.

1947 APR 30 PM 10 39

WILLIAM GREEN=

RECEIVED

PRESIDENT AFL AFL BLDG WASHDC= MAY 1 1947

RE LETTER APRIL 25TH SOUTH CAROLINA GENERAL ASSEMBLY STILL IN SESSION TO ANTI LABOR BILLS STILL HELD UP RESULT OUR FIGHT IT IS ABSOLUTELY NECESSARY THAT I REMAIN HERE DURING LEGISLATIVE DAYS. FIRST VICE PRESIDENT PAUL ROSS OF SC FEDERATION OF LABOR HAS BEEN ASSIGNED BY MYSELF TO IMMEDIATELY COME TO WASHINGTON AS REQUESTED IN YOUR LETTE

EARL R BRITTON PRES SC FEDERATION OF LABOR...

THE COMPANY WILL APPRECIATE SUGGESTIONS FROM ITS PATRONS CONCERNING ITS SERVICE

TELEGRAM
UNION
JOSEPH L. EGAN
PRESIDENT

1201

SYMBOLS
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Ship Radiogram

1947 APR 30 AM 10 44

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(42)

KW37 PD=JACKSONVILLE FLO 30 1014A

C HUSHING= 607

=ROOM ~~YPU~~ AMERICAN FEDERATION OF LABOR BLDG=

WILL ARRIVE WASHINGTON THIS PM AS REQUESTED BY EXECUTIVE
COUNCIL. PLEASE ARRANGE HOTEL RESERVATION HAMILTON PREF

=C G SMITH.

PM.

THE COMPANY WILL APPRECIATE SUGGESTIONS FROM ITS PATRONS CONCERNING ITS SERVICE

THE COMPANY WILL APPRECIATE SUGGESTIONS FROM ITS PATRONS CONCERNING ITS SERVICE

SOUTH CAROLINA FEDERATION ENROUTE. ACKERMAN SECRET
TEXAS FEDERATION TIED UP TEXAS LEGISLATURE AND IS
A REPRESENTATIVE. I WILL COME BACK AS SOON AS TE
FEDERATION CONVENTION ADJOURNS IF NEEDED. REGARI

SGEORGE L GOOGE.(

(48)

This is a fullrate Telegram or Cablegram unless its deferred character is indicated by a suitable symbol above or preceding the address.

WESTERN UNION

A. N. WILLIAMS
PRESIDENT

SYMBOLS
DL=Day Letter
NL=Night Letter
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Ship Radiogram

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1947 APR 30 PM 4 4?

CB218 PD=WUX CHICAGO ILL 30 333P

W C HUSING CHAIRMAN NATIONAL LEGISLATIVE COMMITTEE=
ROOM 607 AMERICAN FEDERATION OF LABOR BLDG 901
MASSACHUSETTS AVE NW WASHDC=

MAURICE LYNCH OUR FINANCIAL SECRETARY HAS BEEN DESIGNATED TO REPRESENT CHICAGO FEDERATION OF LABOR TO ASSIST YOUR COMMITTEE IN YOUR EFFORT TO DEFEAT ANTI-LABOR BILLS BEFORE CONGRESS. HE WILL CONTACT YOU UPON ARRIVAL IN WASHINGTON NEXT MONDAY=

WILLIAM A LEE PRESIDENT CHICAGO FEDERATION OF LABOR.

THE COMPANY WILL APPRECIATE SUGGESTIONS FROM ITS PATRONS CONCERNING ITS SERVICE

Class of Service

This is a fast Telegram or cable unless its deferred character is indicated by a suitable symbol above or preceding the address.

(55)

WESTERN UNION

1201

1947 APR 30

JOSEPH L. EGAN
PRESIDENT

SYMBOLS

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Ship Radiogram

The filing time shown in the date line on telegrams and day letters is STANDARD TIME at point of origin. Time of receipt is STANDARD TIME at point of destination

WV68 PD=LINCOLN NEBR 30 1003A

WM GREEN, RES AFL=

AFL BLDG=

RECEIVED
APR 30 1947

=REFERENCE TO LETTER OF APRIL 25 TO GEO F WILLIAMS SECY NEBR STATE FEDERATION OF LABOR WILL SEND REPRESENTATIVES TO WASHINGTON ON MONDAY MAY 5=

E F NOBLE ACTING PRES NEBR STATE FEDERATION OF LABOR.

25 5.

THE COMPANY WILL APPRECIATE SUGGESTIONS FROM ITS PATRONS CONCERNING ITS SERVICE

SOUTH CAROLINA FEDERATION ENROUTE. ACKERMAN SECRETA
TEXAS FEDERATION TIED UP TEXAS LEGISLATURE AND IS S
A REPRESENTATIVE. I WILL COME BACK AS SOON AS TE
FEDERATION CONVENTION ADJOURNS IF NEEDED. REGARD

SGEORGE L GOOGE.

Class of Service

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WESTERN UNION

1201

A. N. WILLIAMS
PRESIDENT

SYMBOLS

DL=Day Letter
NL=Night Letter
LC=Deferred Cable
NLT=Cable Night Letter
Ship Radiogram

1947 APR 30 PM 3 33

The ... point of origin. Time of receipt is STANDARD TIME at point of destination

WV186 PD=TU ATLANTA GA 30 422P

BILL HUSHING, CHAIRMAN LEGISLAT=VE COMMITTEE=

AMERICAN FEDERATION OF LABOR 6TH FLOOR A F OF L

BL

RFINK AND BROWN FROM NORTH CAROLINA ENROUTE TO WASHINGTON.
ALABAMA STATE PRESIDENT BROCK AND MINERS DISTRICTPRESIDENT
MITCH AT WASHINGTON. SENATOR MCKELLARS FRIEND LORING OF
MEMPHIS JUST OUT OF HOSPITAL YESTERDAY. DOCTOR WILL NOT
PERMIT HIM GOING TO WASHNGTON UNTIL MIDDLE OF NEXT WEEK.
GRAMLING PRESIDENT GEORGIA FEDERATION WILL COME IF
REQUESTED BY PRESIDENT MALONEY INTERNATIONAL OPERATING
ENGINEERS. HE IS MALONEYS VICE PRESIDENT. HATCHELL SECRET
SOUTH CAROLINA FEDERATION ENROUTE. ACKERMAN SECRETARY
TEXAS FEDERATION TIED UP TEXAS LEGISLATURE AND IS SENDI
A REPRESENTATIVE. I WILL COME BACK AS SOON AS TE NNESS'
FEDERATI ON CONV ENT ION ADJOURNS IF NEEDED. REGARD

SG EORGE L GOOGE.(

WESTERN UNION

California State Federation of Labor

[redacted]

[redacted]

Sacramento, California
[redacted]

April 24, 1947

Mr. Wm. Green, President
American Federation of Labor
A. F. of L. Building
Washington, D. C.

RECEIVED
MAY 5 1947

Dear Sir and Brother:

I have your letter of April 23rd addressed to the headquarters of the Federation in San Francisco and forwarded to me here at our legislative headquarters in Sacramento for reply.

I deeply regret that I am not in position at the present time to comply with your request to come to Washington for the purpose of influencing the Senators on anti-labor bills H.R. 3020 and S. 1126 now being considered by the Congress. I am up to my neck in the task of combatting similar bills here in the Legislature in Sacramento. Every one of the provisions contained in H.R. 3020 and S. 1126 are submitted to the Legislature here in separate measures, and I am reluctant to advise that before you receive this letter, Senate Bill 140, commonly referred to as "Hot Cargo" will have passed the second House and be on its way to the Governor. We are hopeful the Governor will veto this measure but to date he has given no indication of what his action will be.

Since receipt of your letter, I have tried to find an official of the State Federation whom I could send to Washington to work against these two measures, but regret that President Real is unable to get away because of a very critical condition existing in Oakland, and the other Vice-Presidents who I feel are qualified to give assistance to you are in similar positions.

2. Mr. Wm. Green

We will keep wiring and writing our two Senators, as well as all our Congressmen from California, urging them to oppose these measures.

Yours fraternally

C. J. Haggerty
Secretary

CJH/mk
oeiu-3-afl(31)

Calvert 6780

COPY

EXECUTIVE OFFICES

BALTIMORE FEDERATION OF LABOR

39 SOUTH STREET

BALTIMORE 2 MARYLAND

April 30, 1947

Mr. William Green, President
American Federation of Labor
A. F. of L. Building
Washington 1, D. C.

Dear Sir and Brother:

April 30, 1947

Mr. William Green, President
American Federation of Labor
Washington 1, D. C.

Dear Sir and Brother:

In reply to your letter of April 25th, with regard to the President, Secretary or one or two members of the Executive Board going to Washington to discuss anti-labor legislation with the U. S. Senators and Representatives, we wish to say that most of our delegates, especially our board members, will be attending the Pennsylvania Federation of Labor Convention in Harrisburg for the next four or five days.

Upon their return to the City, I will be glad to take this matter up with the Executive Board, and if possible, we will send a delegate or two to Washington as requested.

I would like to say further that we keep in close contact with our Allegheny County Congressmen and Senators on all anti-labor legislation, and especially that opposed by the American Federation of Labor.

You may fee assured that we will cooperate with the American Federation of Labor one hundred per cent.

Sincerely and fraternally yours,

PITTSBURGH CENTRAL LABOR UNION

John A. Stackhouse

John A. Stackhouse
Secretary

JAS:EM

OEIU-33

cc: Mr. George Meany, Secretary-Treasurer ✓

RECEIVED MAY 2 - 1947

MAY 2 - 1947

Calvert 6780

EXECUTIVE OFFICES

BALTIMORE FEDERATION OF LABOR

39 SOUTH STREET

BALTIMORE 2 MARYLAND

April 30, 1947

Mr. William Green, President
American Federation of Labor
A. F. of L. Building
Washington 1, D. C.

Dear Sir and Brother:

Your letter of April 25 in re an officer of this Central Body coming to Washington for ten days to two weeks to aid opposition to anti-labor bills (H.R. 3020 and S. 1126) was referred to our Federation at its meeting last evening.

I have been instructed to advise you that this Federation stands ready to render you its every cooperation. We will have our representatives contact Chairman Hushing, as per your suggestion.

Assuring you of our every desire to assist in any way possible, and with every wish for your continued success, we are,

Sincerely and fraternally yours,

BALTIMORE FEDERATION OF LABOR

Harry Cohen, President

hc : p
o e i u
#22-afl
cc: George Meany
W. C. Hushing

RECEIVED MAY 2 - 1947

Calvert 6780

EXECUTIVE OFFICES

BALTIMORE FEDERATION OF LABOR

39 SOUTH STREET

BALTIMORE 2 MARYLAND

April 30, 1947

Mr. William Green, President
American Federation of Labor
A. F. of L. Building
Washington 1, D. C.

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Sincerely and fraternally yours,

BALTIMORE FEDERATION OF LABOR

Harry Cohen, President

hc : p
f22-afl
cc: George Meany
W. C. Hushing

California State Federation of Labor

VICE-PRESIDENTS
K. G. BITTER, District No. 1
525 E Street, San Diego (1)
JACK T. ARNOLD, District No. 2
324 E. 4th Street, Long Beach
ELMER J. DORAN, District No. 3
937 Third Street, San Bernardino
LEONARD GRAHAM, District No. 8
201 Labor Temple, Los Angeles (13)
C. T. LEHMANN, District No. 8
301 Labor Temple, Los Angeles (13)
THOMAS L. PITTS, District No. 8
946 South Union Ave., Los Angeles (14)
PAT SOMERSET, District No. 8
7046 Hollywood Blvd., Hollywood (28)
MAE STONEMAN, District No. 8
910 South Broadway, Los Angeles (15)
FRANK KRASNESKY, District No. 4
351 West Ninth Street, San Pedro
LOLETA GRANDE CHENEY, District No. 5
15 East Ortega Street, Santa Barbara
PAUL REEVES, District No. 6
1035 Broadway, Fresno (1)
C. A. GREEN, District No. 7
1005 F Street, Modesto
ANTHONY AGRILLO, District No. 8
P. O. Box 494, San Jose

CHARLES W. REAL
PRESIDENT
C. J. HAGGERTY
SECRETARY-TREASURER
402 FLOOD BUILDING, SAN FRANCISCO (2)
SUTTER 2898

VICE-PRESIDENTS
ARTHUR F. DOUGHERTY, District No. 9
1623½ Market Street, San Francisco (3)
GEORGE KELLY, District No. 9
3705 Twenty-fifth Street, San Francisco (14)
HARRY LUNDEBERG, District No. 9
59 Clay Street, San Francisco (11)
VICTOR S. SWANSON, District No. 9
1095 Market Street, San Francisco (3)
ROBERT S. ASH, District No. 10
2111 Webster Street, Oakland (12)
CHAS. A. ROE, District No. 10
529 Soto Street, Hayward
HOWARD REED, District No. 11
729 Castro Street, Martinez
LOWELL NELSON, District No. 12
P. O. Box 618, Vallejo
HARRY FINKS, District No. 13
2315A L Street, Sacramento (14)
ALBIN J. GRUHN, District No. 14
Box 259, Eureka
EARL MILLER, District No. 15
Box 692, Westwood, Lassen County

Very Rev. Msgr. MARTIN C. KEATING, Chaplain
CHARLES P. SCULLY, Legal Adviser

April 30, 1947

Mr. Wm. Green, President
American Federation of Labor
A. F. of L. Building
Washington 1, D.C.

RECEIVED
MAY 6 1947

Dear Sir and Brother:

This will acknowledge receipt of your letter of April 25, requesting that either the Secretary or I come to Washington anent influencing our Senators and representatives against the pending anti-labor bills.

I regret to inform you that it will be impossible for either Mr. Haggerty or myself to respond to this request in person. I am now engaged in negotiating agreements for my membership, which requires my presence here. Brother Haggerty is fully occupied in Sacramento where there are a number of measures similar to the Hartley bill that the state legislature is trying to pass.

In considering another possible choice, it was our opinion that we could help you more effectively by contacting our Senators and representatives from here regarding HR 3020 and S 1126.

If there is any other assistance we can render, please let us know and we shall be only too glad to do so.

Fraternally yours,

Chas. W. Real

Charles W. Real
President

CWR.kd
OEIU-3-AFL(31)

Pres Secretary

C

for

April 30, 1947

Mr. Lee W. Minton, President
Glass Bottle Blowers Association of the
United States and Canada
Philadelphia Saving Fund Building
12 South 12th Street
Philadelphia 7, Pennsylvania

Dear Sir and Brother:

I acknowledge receipt of your letter dated April 17 and under separate cover the petition you forwarded to this office. Immediately upon receipt of the petition I placed it in the hands of our Legislative Representative and pictures have been taken with one of the United States Senators. I will transmit copy of the picture to you at my earliest opportunity.

Fraternally yours,

President
American Federation of Labor

ams

Sincerely and fraternally yours,

PITTSBURGH CENTRAL LABOR UNION

John A. Stackhouse

John A. Stackhouse
Secretary

JAS:MM

CBTU-33

cc: Mr. George Meany, Secretary-Treasurer

Pittsburgh Central Labor Union

Affiliated with

The American Federation of Labor

M. JOHN DORSEY
PRESIDENT

JOHN A. STACKHOUSE
SECRETARY

1305 KEENAN BUILDING
643 LIBERTY AVENUE PITTSBURGH 22, PENNA.

ATlantic 7637

CENTRAL LABOR UNION · AMERICAN FEDERATION OF LABOR · PITTSBURGH, PENNA.
RECEIVED
MAY 1 1947

April 30, 1947

Mr. William Green, President
American Federation of Labor
Washington 1, D. C.

Dear Sir and Brother:

In reply to your letter of April 25th, with regard to the President, Secretary or one or two members of the Executive Board going to Washington to discuss anti-labor legislation with the U. S. Senators and Representatives, we wish to say that most of our delegates, especially our board members, will be attending the Pennsylvania Federation of Labor Convention in Harrisburg for the next four or five days.

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You may fee assured that we will cooperate with the American Federation of Labor one hundred per cent.

Sincerely and fraternally yours,

PITTSBURGH CENTRAL LABOR UNION

John A. Stackhouse

John A. Stackhouse
Secretary

JAS:EM

OEIU-33

cc: Mr. George Meany, Secretary-Treasurer

Amalgamated Meat Cutters and Butcher Workmen of North America
Local Union 423

AFFILIATED WITH A. F. OF L.

JOSEPH CONRAD, JR., PRESIDENT
ALFRED V. LANDES, FINANCIAL SECRETARY

OFFICE 3019 1-2 BROADWAY
FORT WAYNE 6, INDIANA

April 30, 1947.

Mr. William C. Hushing
Chairman National Legislative Committee
Room 607. American Federation of Labor Bld'g
901.Massachusetts Avenue N.W.
Washington D.C.

Dear Sir and Brother:

I have been elected by the Fort Wayne Federation of Labor to alternate for President Robert E. Leach at the request of President William Green regarding pending legislation on The "Taft Ball/Labor Bill".

For your information I will arrive in Washington Monday morning and will contact you immediately upon my arrival.

I would appreciate greatly your making Hotel reservations for my stay in Washington.; I will in all probability be there for ten days to two weeks, and you may wire me collect the name of the Hotel.

With kind personal regards, I am,

Yours fraternally,

Alfred V Landes

Alfred V. Landes
Fin-Sec'y Local
423.

EXECUTIVE BOARD

JOSEPH CONRAD, JR. PRESIDENT
FRED VOLMERDING VICE-PRESIDENT
BRUCE B. HUTCHISON TREASURER
ALFRED V. LANDES FINANCIAL SECRETARY
EDWARD BROOKS RECORDING SECRETARY